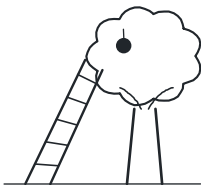


How will we get from here to there?



Theory of Change, after Ingrid Burkett.

Your best guess about how change will happen. It's a guess, not a plan, so test it and change it. Try many things, but head for one good place, described clearly enough that you'll know it when you get there. Best done with a few people, so there's some healthy disagreement.

THREE STEPS

- 1 Fill the two ends first. What are you trying to understand, and what's it like when you get there?
- 2 Draw a rough star on anything in the middle you have to do anyway, like a programme a funder requires.
- 3 Fill the middle. Work back from the good place, forward from where you are, or out from the stars. Then check that every star joins up to both ends.

FOR EXAMPLE

A sports club that keeps losing its teenagers.

IF	"Understand what teens want"
BY	"a Friday social session"
BY	"older players coach the younger ones"
BY	★ "a holiday camp (the grant needs it)"
THEN	"a Friday group that runs all term"
THEN	"a coaching roster for older players"
& THEN	"teens bring mates, and stay"
& EVENTUALLY	"teens still playing at 17, with friends"

Three things to try, one good place. The holiday camp is the star to check. If it doesn't lead there, say so, even if you still have to run it.

THEN TALK ABOUT IT

Where do we feel pull, and where push?

Talk about which parts you want to do, and which you're being made to do. Those feelings are signs too.

GOING FURTHER

Use it more than once. Keep a photo of your first map. When something new turns up, check it against the arrows. At the end, compare your first good place with where you got to.

Watch for the stars quietly becoming the whole plan, or the map turning into something you defend rather than test.

THE CHANGE WE'RE WORKING ON



★ a given, not a choice

↔ work back, forward, or out from the stars

Growing Innovation Capability in Teams – a relational approach

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